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SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "MINERVOIS"

approved by the order of 7 December 2020 published in the JORF of 10 December 2020

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Minervois", initially recognised by the decree of 15 February 1985.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colours and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Minervois" is reserved for still white, rosé and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes:

- Aude department: Aigues-Vives, Argeliers, Argens-Minervois, Azille, Badens, Bagnoles, Bize-Minervois, Blomac, Bouilhonnac, Cabrespine, Castelnau-d'Aude, Caunes-Minervois, Ginestas, Homps, Laure-Minervois, Limousis, Mailhac, Malves-en-Minervois, Marseillette, Mirepeisset, Paraza, Pépieux, Peyriac-Minervois, Pouzols-Minervois, Puichéric, La Redorte, Rieux-Minervois, Roquecourbe-Minervois, Roubia, Rustiques, Saint-Couat-d'Aude, Saint-Frichoux, Saint-Nazaired'Aude, Sainte-Valière, Sallèles-Cabardès, Salsigne, Tourouzelle, Trassanel, Trausse, Trèbes, Ventenac-en-Minervois, Villalier, Villarzel-Cabardès, Villegly, Villeneuve-Minervois.

- Hérault department: Agel, Aigne, Aigues-Vives, Azillanet, Beaufort, Cassagnoles, La Caunette, Cesseras, Félines-Minervois, La Livinière, Minerve, Montouliers, Olonzac, Oupia, Saint-Jean-de-Minervois, Siran.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 20 September 1984 and of 18 and 19 June 2019. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes concerned the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Aude department: Barbaira, Berriac, Canet, Capendu, Carcassonne, Castans, Citou, Conques-sur-Orbiel, Douzens, Escales, Floure, Fontiès-d'Aude, Fournes-Cabardès, Labastide-Esparbairenque, Lastours, Lespinassière, Lézignan-Corbières, Marcorignan, Montbrun-des-Corbières, Montirat, Moux, Ouveillan, Pradelles-Cabardès, Raissac, Saint-Marcel-d'Aude, Sallèles-d'Aude, Villanière, Villardonnel, Villedubert, Villemoustaussou.

- Hérault department: Assignan, Cruzy, Ferrals-les-Montagnes, Villespassans.

V. – Grape varieties

The grape varieties are understood as those of all of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin for the colour considered.

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the following varieties:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	GRAPE VARIETIES
Red wines	- main varieties: grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: carignan N, cinsaut N, piquepoul noir N, rivairenc N, terret noir N.
Rosé wines	- main varieties: grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B, carignan N, cinsaut N, clairette B, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, maccabeu B, marsanne B, piquepoul blanc B, piquepoul noir N, rivairenc N, roussanne B, terret blanc B, terret noir N, vermentino B.
White wines	- main varieties: bourboulenc B, grenache blanc B, maccabeu B, marsanne B, roussanne B, vermentino B; - accessory varieties: clairette B, grenache gris G, muscat à petits grains B, piquepoul blanc B, terret blanc B, viognier blanc B.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres and the spacing between plants within the same row may not be less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

Pruning is carried out before stage E, 3 leaves spread out on the first 2 free eyes. - The vines are pruned by short pruning with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant. Each spur bears a maximum of 2 free eyes. - The marsanne B, roussanne B and syrah N varieties may be pruned by single Guyot with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant, of which a maximum of 6 free eyes on the long cane and a maximum of 2 replacement spurs bearing a maximum of 2 free eyes each.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

COLOUR OF THE WINES	PROPORTION RULES ON THE HOLDING
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Red wines	- The proportion of the grenache N, lledonner pelut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties, together or separately, is greater than or equal to 60 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the piquepoul noir N, rivairenc N and terret noir N varieties, together or separately, is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties.
Rosé wines	- The proportion of the grenache N, lledonner pelut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties, together or separately, is greater than or equal to 60 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the grenache gris G variety is less than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the piquepoul noir N, rivairenc N and terret noir N varieties, together or separately, is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the white varieties is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties.
White wines	- The proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 80 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the muscat à petits grains B variety is less than or equal to 10 %. - The proportion of the viognier blanc B variety is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties.

PARTICULAR PROVISION

These obligations do not apply to operators producing grapes who do not vinify their production, and whose holding: - has an area classified within the delimited parcel area of less than 1.50 hectare; - respects a proportion of main varieties greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties for the colour considered.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
- For the vines trained in the “raised single-plane trellising” mode, the height of the trellised foliage, after topping, must be at least equal to 0.45 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire. - For all the other training methods, the length of the shoots, after topping, is greater than or equal to 0.70 metre. - All of these rules apply only from 30 June of each year.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,500 kilograms per hectare. - When irrigation is authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Thresholds for missing vines.
- The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %. - For the vines whose planting density is greater than or equal to 5,000 plants per hectare, the percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 30 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar richness of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume meet the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines	192	12 %
Red and rosé wines	202	12 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 48 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 60 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and

once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties.

COLOUR OF THE WINES	PROVISIONS FOR THE BLENDS
Red wines	- The wines come from the blending of grapes, of musts or of wines arising from at least 2 varieties, of which one main variety; - the proportion of all the carignan N, cinsaut N, grenache N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 50 % of the blend. A single one of these varieties may not represent more than 80 %.
Rosé wines	- The wines come from the blending of grapes, of musts or of wines, with the exception of wines arising from the white varieties when these are vinified separately, arising from at least 2 varieties, of which one main variety; - the proportion of all the carignan N, cinsaut N, grenache N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 50 % of the blend; - the proportion of the most important variety is less than or equal to 80 %; - the proportion of the white varieties, together or separately, is less than or equal to 10 %.
White wines	- The proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 80 % of the blend; - the proportion of the muscat à petits grains blancs B variety is less than or equal to 10 %.

b) – Malolactic fermentation.

The red wines, ready to be marketed in bulk or packaged, present a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.

The wines, ready to be marketed in bulk or packaged, present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) meeting the following values:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MAXIMUM CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS (glucose + fructose) (grams per litre)
Red wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 14 %)	3
Red wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 14 %)	4
Rosé wines	4
White wines	4

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.

For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use, alone or in a mixture in preparations, is prohibited.

e) – Prohibited equipment.

- The use of continuous vinifiers, of vats with marc recycling, of vertical centrifugal destemmers is prohibited. - Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vinification vat capacity.

Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equivalent to the volume vinified during the previous harvest.

g) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment.
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging and, in this latter case, within a maximum time limit of fifteen days following the packaging. The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator has a place suited to the storage of the packaged products.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers.
The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	DATE
Rosé and white wines	15 November of the year of harvest
Red wines	1 December of the year of harvest

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is backed against the Montagne Noire, the most southern part of the Cévennes, with as its culminating point the Pic de Nore (1,210 metres). The vineyard lies at the heart of a vast amphitheatre that descends regularly from north to south to end in a gentle slope near the river Aude. Totally exposed to the south, it is bordered by 2 sets of hills: - one close to Carcassonne, towards the west, constituted of hills oriented north/south from Salsigne to Trèbes, and at the heart of which winds the river Clamoux; - the other, towards the east, christened “la serre d’Oupia”, crossed by the river Cesse. The centre of the geographical area overlooks by about a hundred metres the lagoon of Marseillette to lie then in continuity towards a great plateau crossed by the rivers of the “Argent-Double” and of the “Ognon”, tributaries of the Aude. Crossing hills and plains, the “Minervoise” road makes it possible to discover a vineyard that composes harmoniously with the natural environment dotted with garrigues, pines and oaks. The geographical area belongs to a wide syncline, resting to the north on the Massif of the Montagne Noire, and filled with tertiary molassic sediments, cut by beds of sandstone and by conglomerates of lacustrine limestones. The most characteristic soils are thus developed on stony terraces, marls, sandstones, alterations (degradation) of hard limestone and on a few lenses of schist in the zones of altitude. The climate is Mediterranean, characterised by a great mildness, a relative dryness, an average annual rainfall of 630 millimetres and an average annual temperature greater than 14 °C, with an annual sunshine greater than 2,400 hours. In its eastern part, the geographical area benefits from Mediterranean maritime influences that manifest themselves by humid south-east breezes in summer and low spring or autumn precipitation. On the opposite, to the west, the geographical area is subject to the effects of the north-west wind (Cers), often violent and generally dry, but which, on contact with the Montagne Noire, is at the origin, mainly in autumn and in spring, of oceanic precipitation. The geographical area thus extends over the territory of 45 communes of the Aude department and 16 communes of the Hérault department.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The vine is present in the “Minervois” since the Roman era. PLINY THE YOUNGER, VARRO and CICERO attest in their writings to the presence of a prestigious vineyard on the hillsides, in 70 before

Jesus Christ, which, strong in its success, leads the emperor DOMITIAN, in 92, to forbid any new planting in the province, in order to avoid competition. In 280, PROBUS abolishes this law, thus favouring the exports towards the provinces of the West, of the North and of Germania. The following great invasions do not affect the vineyard, with the exception of the Saracen invasions that slow its expansion in the 7th to the 9th century. The Canal du Midi, opened in 1680, the improvement of the road network in the 18th century, then the arrival of the railway, contribute to the development of the vineyard, imposing the vine in monoculture. This prosperity is subject to the hazards of the phylloxera crisis and of overproduction, with as its climax the wine crisis of 1907 that imposes on the whole region a deep reorganisation. To the east of the geographical area is found the village of Argeliers, from where, in 1907, the winegrower Marcellin ALBERT sounds the revolt of the French winegrowers against fraud and the poor sale of wine. From this period of serious troubles that inflames the whole Midi, and a part of winegrowing France, is born the law instituting the "designation of origin". A defence union is created in the region of the Minervois in 1922. Recognised at first as designation of origin "vins délimités de qualité supérieure" in 1951, the "Minervois" is recognised as controlled designation of origin by decree of 15 February 1985, after a reconversion of the grape varieties in favour above all of the black varieties grenache N, syrah N, mourvèdre N and cinsaut N, noble plants of former times, and of the white varieties grenache B, maccabeu B, roussanne B, marsanne B, vermentino B, and the establishment of rigorous production conditions. In order to better master the latter, the operators opt in 1996 for a particular procedure that requires the allocation of the parcels intended for the harvesting of the grapes two years before any claim. In 2009, 124,000 hectolitres are claimed in controlled designation of origin by 210 private cellars and 25 cooperative cellars, which produce 40 % of the volumes. The red wines represent 92 % of the production and the rosé wines 6 % of the volumes.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The red wines arise, according to the usages, from grape varieties in which the grenache N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties are present at least at 60 %. They present a purple robe with violet reflections. Their balance and their aromatic richness recalling red fruits permit a consumption in their youth. Warm and powerful, and developing aromatic notes often spicy or liquorice-like, they offer the guarantee of a good aptitude for ageing. The rosé wines present a light and salmon-coloured hue, and an aromatic palette recalling red fruits. They are at once fresh and powerful, harmonious and persistent. The white wines present a pale-gold robe with green reflections. Complex and warm, with marked floral accents, they bring on the palate lively notes of fresh fruits such as peach, mango or apricot.

3° – Causal interactions

The conjunction of the Mediterranean climate and of the topography with a south exposure, swept by the prevailing winds, vectors of low precipitation, confers on the geographical area an aptitude for the cultivation of an original vineyard on the predominantly clayey-calcareous soils. These particular conditions are propitious to an optimal ripeness of the grape and offer the winegrower the possibility of an adequacy between the variety and the viticultural situation, an adequacy that contributes to the particular expression of the wines. The grenache N variety brings warmth and roundness on the palate and appreciates the stony terraces and the marls. The syrah N variety, an early variety, brings sugar richness and aromas of red fruits. Historical varieties, the cinsaut N variety, traditionally reserved for rosé wine, also enters into the blend of the red wines to bring all its finesse, and the carignan N variety brings body and tannins and, at high ripeness, particular liquorice-like aromas. As for the mourvèdre N variety, it brings fine tannins and spicy accents. Jacques PUISAIS describes thus the link of the product with its natural environment: "The Minervois is a wine of air and what counts is the vintage of the wind and in particular in the period that precedes the harvest, this conditions the speed of the evapotranspiration. This wine of air is characterised by the mildness and the richness of the tannin and the original respect of the fruit". Viticulture punctuates the history of the "Minervois" for 2 millennia. Minerve, a village with mythological evocations, perched on a rocky peak of the calcareous causse, gave its name to the controlled designation of origin. This ancient stronghold is known for its exceptional site and for its resistance to Simon de Montfort, during the crusade against the Cathars in 1210. On this emblematic site, characteristic of the sites of the controlled designation of origin, the vine, established on the hard limestones, rubs shoulders with a southern landscape of an intense luminosity. The references to the Roman empire remain present. Most of the current estates and châteaux are established on the antique "domus", such as "Massanier la Mignarde" on the commune of Pépieux, a former property of the legionary MAXIMUS and

whose wine is consecrated best wine in the World in 2005 by the "International Wine Challenge". On the western edge of the geographical area, the city of Carcassonne, a medieval stronghold listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, belongs to the cultural and historical heritage of the "Minervois". To the south of the geographical area winds the Canal du Midi, at the origin of the economic rise of the 17th century, a canal also listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The controlled designation of origin "Minervois" thus testifies, by its historical capital and its privileged sites, to a deep attachment to the cultivation of the vine anchored on its territory.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

The following operator, known as vinifying its wines in the commune situated outside the geographical area at the date of 31 July 2009, may continue these operations within the territory of this commune, until the 2019 harvest inclusive, subject to compliance with the other provisions of the specification:

OPERATOR	COMMUNE
Château le Bouchat-Alaux	Pennautier (Aude)

2° – Training methods

a) – The vine parcels planted before 31 August 2003 and presenting a planting density between 3,300 plants per hectare and 4,000 plants per hectare and/or a spacing between rows greater than 2.5 metres continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the trellising and foliage-height rules fixed in the present specification.

b) – The vine parcels planted before 31 August 2003, and presenting a planting density less than or equal to 3,300 plants per hectare and/or a spacing between rows greater than 2.5 metres, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to the foliage height making it possible to have 1.40 square metres of external surface of plant cover for the production of one kilogram of grapes.

c) – The vine parcels in place at the date of 31 July 2009 and presenting a spacing between plants within the same row less than 0.80 metre continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the trellising and foliage-height rules fixed in the present specification.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Minervois" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Languedoc" by the reference "Grand Vin du Languedoc". The dimensions of the characters of this larger geographical unit are not greater, both in height and in width, than half those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin. The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, subject to: - it being a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appearing on the harvest declaration. The name of the registered cadastral lieu-dit is entered immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions are not greater, both in height and in width, than half those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel allocation

a) – Each operator declares, before 31 March of the second year preceding the first claim declaration, to the defence and management body, the list of the parcels allocated to the production of the controlled designation of origin. The operator has this time limit to bring its parcels into conformity with the provisions fixed in the present specification. The declaration specifies: - the identity of the operator; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the cooperative cellar(s) to which it is, where applicable, a supplier; - for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the year of planting, the variety, the planting density, the spacings on the row and between rows. It is accompanied by the list of the parcels presenting a percentage of dead or missing plants greater than 20 % or 30 %, established in accordance with the provisions of Article 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, as well as by the identification of the parcels liable to be irrigated.

b) – The parcels having been the subject of a renunciation to produce, or not claimed in the controlled designation of origin for two successive harvests without justification duly motivated by a climatic accident, must be the subject of a new prior declaration of parcel allocation according to the arrangements referred to in a) above.

c) – The declaration of renunciation as provided for in the specification of the controlled designation of origin “Minervois-La Livinière” is equivalent to a prior declaration of parcel allocation for the parcels respecting the production conditions of the controlled designation of origin “Minervois” and subject to being lodged before 15 August preceding the harvest, or until the start of the harvest in the event of a climatic accident.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

The operator may declare, to the defence and management body, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin, until 15 August preceding the harvest, or until the start of the harvest in the event of a climatic accident. This declaration specifies for each parcel whether it is intended for the production of a more general controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration as soon as possible to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin, as well as to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin.

3. Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body before 31 May of the year following that of the harvest and at least 10 days before the first transaction or packaging declaration. It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts.

4. Declaration of transactions and of removals

Every operator wishing to market in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends to the approved control body a transaction declaration for the lot concerned, on the day of the contractualisation of the transaction or at least within the five (working) days following it, and at least ten working days before the removal.

5. Packaging declaration

Every operator wishing to package a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make to the approved control body a packaging declaration for the lot concerned at the latest ten working days after the operation. The operators carrying out more than twelve packagings per year are exempted from this declaration obligation, but must send monthly a summary declaration.

6. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the approved

control body at least ten working days before the dispatch. The operator specifies the volumes concerned.

7. Fallback (repli) declaration

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body at least seven working days before this fallback.

8. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body at the latest seven working days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

The following registers are filled in regularly and are kept available for the approved control body.

1. Register relating to the transitional provisions

List of the parcels being the subject of transitional provisions relating to the training method, in particular for the vines presenting a density lower than 3,300 plants per hectare.

2. Cellar plan

Cellar plan permitting in particular the number, the designation and the capacity of the containers to be identified.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential (training method, entry of the vines into production, monitoring of the transitional measures, prior declaration of parcel allocation, missing vines).	Documentary check and check in the field.
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facility. — Belonging of the place of vinification to the geographical area or to the immediate proximity area.	Documentary and/or on-site check.
Prohibited equipment.	Documentary check and on-site check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning and density.	Documentary check and check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field.
Irrigation.	Check in the field.
Overall upkeep.	Check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices and treatments.	Documentary check and on-site check.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Prior declaration of parcel allocation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary.

Claim declaration.	Documentary check and on-site check.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the movement of the products between approved warehouse keepers or at the placing on the market for the consumer.	Documentary and/or analytical check; organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04
Email: info@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved control plan.

The control plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.